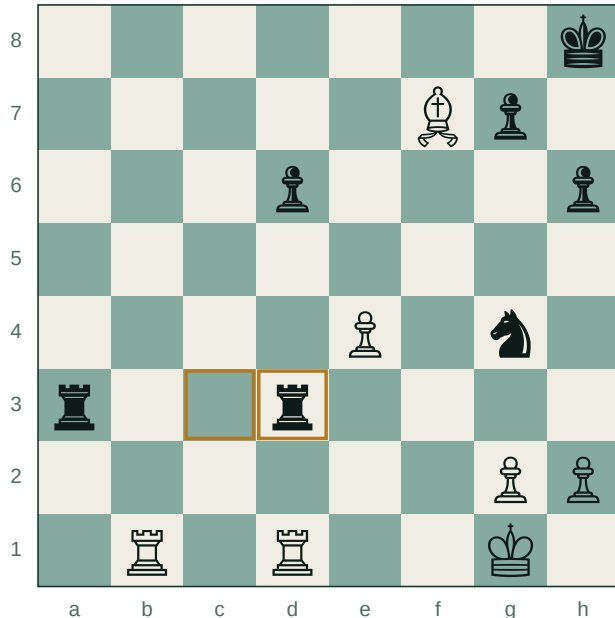


Active defensive resources: White, move 37

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 36...Rxd3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

37. Rxd3 Rxd3 38. Bg6

37.Rxd3 The rook captures the rook on d3. Recorded reply: **37...Rxd3**.

38.Bg6 The bishop moves from f7 to g6.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on h8. Geometrically undefended: knight on g4. Check for tactical protection.